

HTML Tags Reference Guide

Block-Level Tags

Tag	Type	Key Attributes
<div>	Block	class, id, style
<p>	Block	title, class, id, style
<h1> to <h6>	Block	class, id, style
<address>	Block	class, id, style
<blockquote>	Block	cite, class, id, style
	Block	type, start, reversed
	Block	type
	Block	value
<dl>	Block	class, id, style
<dt>	Block	class, id, style
<dd>	Block	class, id, style
<table>	Block	border, cellpadding, cellspacing
<tr>	Block	class, id, style
<th>	Block	rowspan, colspan
<td>	Block	rowspan, colspan
<caption>	Block	align, class, id, style
<form>	Block	action, method
<fieldset>	Block	class, id, style
<legend>	Block	class, id, style

Tag	Type	Key Attributes
<textarea>	Block	rows, cols, name, required, readonly, disabled, placeholder
<button>	Block	type, disabled, autofocus
<video>	Block	src, controls, autoplay, loop, muted, poster, width, height
<audio>	Block	src, controls, autoplay, loop, muted
<header>	Block	class, id, style
<footer>	Block	class, id, style
<section>	Block	class, id, style
<article>	Block	class, id, style
<main>	Block	class, id, style
<nav>	Block	class, id, style
<aside>	Block	class, id, style
<datalist>	Block	id
<details>	Block	class, id, style
<colgroup>	Block	span

Inline-Level Tags

Tag	Type	Key Attributes
	Inline	class, id, style
	Inline	src, alt, height, width
<a>	Inline	href, target, title, accesskey
	Inline	class, id, style
<i>	Inline	class, id, style
<u>	Inline	class, id, style
	Inline	class, id, style

Tag	Type	Key Attributes
	Inline	class, id, style
<ins>	Inline	class, id, style
<sup>	Inline	class, id, style
<sub>	Inline	class, id, style
<code>	Inline	class, id, style
<q>	Inline	class, id, style
<abbr>	Inline	title, class, id, style
	Inline	class, id, style
<input>	Inline	type, name, value, required, readonly, disabled, placeholder, autofocus, min, max, minlength, maxlength, size, multiple, accept, list
<label>	Inline	for, class, id, style
<select>	Inline	name, multiple, required, size, disabled
<option>	Inline	value, selected, disabled
<summary>	Inline	class, id, style
<iframe>	Inline	src, height, width, name, frameborder
<col>	Inline	span, class, id, style
 	Inline	(No attributes)
<source>	Inline	src, type

Key Tag Characteristics

Container Tags (Paired)

Tags that require both opening and closing tags:

- Text formatting: `<b>` , `<i>` , `<u>` , `<em>` , `<strong>` , `<ins>` , `<sup>` , `<sub>` , `<code>` , `<q>` , `<abbr>` , `<del>`
- Structure: `<div>` , `<span>` , `<p>` , `<h1>` to `<h6>` , `<header>` , `<footer>` , `<main>` , `<section>` , `<article>` , `<nav>`
- Lists: `<ol>` , `<ul>` , `<li>` , `<dl>` , `<dt>` , `<dd>`
- Forms: `<form>` , `<fieldset>` , `<legend>` , `<label>` , `<select>` , `<option>` , `<textarea>` , `<datalist>`
- Tables: `<table>` , `<thead>` , `<tbody>` , `<tfoot>` , `<tr>` , `<th>` , `<td>` , `<caption>` , `<colgroup>`
- Media: `<video>` , `<audio>` , `<iframe>`
- Semantic: `<address>` , `<blockquote>` , `<details>` , `<summary>` , `<aside>`

Void/Non-Container Tags (Self-Closing)

Tags that do NOT have closing tags:

- `<img>` - Embed images
- `<input>` - Form input fields
- `<br>` - Line break
- `<hr>` - Horizontal rule
- `<source>` - Media source
- `<col>` - Table column
- `<meta>` - Metadata
- `<link>` - External resources
- `<area>` - Image map area

Common Attributes Explained

Universal Attributes (Available on most tags)

- **class** - Assign CSS class for styling multiple elements
- **id** - Unique identifier for a single element
- **style** - Inline CSS styling
- **title** - Tooltip text on hover
- **contenteditable** - Allow user to edit content (true/false)
- **accesskey** - Keyboard shortcut to activate element

Form Input Attributes

- **type** - Specifies input type (text, email, password, date, number, checkbox, radio, etc.)
- **name** - Name of form field (sent to server on submit)
- **value** - Default/initial value
- **required** - Field must be filled before form submission
- **readonly** - User can view but not modify
- **disabled** - Field is disabled and value not submitted
- **placeholder** - Hint text displayed in empty field
- **autofocus** - Automatically focus on page load
- **min/max** - Minimum/maximum values (for number, date, range)
- **minlength/maxlength** - Character length restrictions
- **size** - Visible width of input field

Image Attributes

- **src** - Path/URL to image file
- **alt** - Alternative text if image fails to load
- **height** - Image height in pixels or percentage
- **width** - Image width in pixels or percentage

Link Attributes

- **href** - URL destination of link
- **target** - Where to open link (_blank = new tab, _self = same tab)
- **title** - Tooltip text

Table Attributes

- **rowspan** - Merge cells across rows
- **colspan** - Merge cells across columns
- **border** - Border width around table
- **cellpadding** - Space inside cells
- **cellspacing** - Space between cells

List Attributes

- **type** - List style (for : 1, A, a, I, i; for : disc, circle, square)

- **start** - Starting number for ordered list
- **reversed** - Reverse numbering order

Media Attributes

- **controls** - Show play, pause, volume controls
- **autoplay** - Automatically start playing
- **loop** - Repeat media when finished
- **muted** - Audio is muted by default
- **poster** - Cover image for video (before play)

Form Elements Attributes

- **action** - URL where form data is sent
- **method** - How data is sent (GET or POST)
- **rows/cols** - Height and width of textarea
- **for** - Connects label to input by matching input's id

Display Type Differences

Block-Level Elements

- Take up the full width available
- Always start on a new line
- Height and width can be set
- Margin and padding are respected
- Examples: `<div>` , `<p>` , `<h1>` , `<section>`

Inline Elements

- Take only the space needed
- Do not start on a new line
- Height and width cannot be set
- Only horizontal margin/padding is respected
- Examples: `<span>` , `<a>` , `<img>` , `<button>`

HTML5 Semantic Tags

These tags give meaning to content structure:

- `<header>` - Top section with logo/navigation
- `<nav>` - Navigation links
- `<main>` - Main content area
- `<section>` - Thematic section
- `<article>` - Independent content
- `<aside>` - Sidebar/supplementary content
- `<footer>` - Bottom section
- `<figure>` - Standalone illustration/diagram
- `<figcaption>` - Caption for figure
- `<details>` - Collapsible disclosure widget
- `<summary>` - Label for details element
- `<mark>` - Highlighted/marked text
- `<time>` - Date/time information
- `<address>` - Contact information

Quick Reference: Input Types

<code>type='text'</code>	– Single-line text input
<code>type='email'</code>	– Email input with validation
<code>type='password'</code>	– Hidden password input
<code>type='number'</code>	– Numeric input with controls
<code>type='date'</code>	– Date picker
<code>type='time'</code>	– Time picker
<code>type='datetime-local'</code>	– Date and time picker
<code>type='month'</code>	– Month and year picker
<code>type='week'</code>	– Week picker
<code>type='color'</code>	– Color picker
<code>type='range'</code>	– Slider control
<code>type='checkbox'</code>	– Multiple selection
<code>type='radio'</code>	– Single selection from group
<code>type='file'</code>	– File upload
<code>type='submit'</code>	– Form submission button
<code>type='reset'</code>	– Reset form to defaults
<code>type='button'</code>	– Generic button
<code>type='search'</code>	– Search input
<code>type='tel'</code>	– Telephone number
<code>type='url'</code>	– URL input

Notes

- All percentage (%) and pixel (px) values should be specified for height/width attributes
- Container tags must have both opening `<tag>` and closing `</tag>`
- Attributes should only be applied to opening tags
- Always use meaningful alt text for images for accessibility
- HTML5 is the current standard version (released 2014)
- Use semantic tags for better SEO and code readability
- Global attributes (class, id, style, title, contenteditable, accesskey) can be used on nearly all elements